

ISO/IEC 42001:2023

AI Management System *Checklist*

A clause-by-clause implementation checklist covering Clauses 4–10
and key Annex A controls. Print, track progress, and prepare for
certification.

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How to use *this checklist*

This PDF is a companion to the interactive checklist at regulome.io/resources/iso-42001-checklist. Use it for offline gap analysis, team workshops, and pre-audit preparation. Each item maps directly to an ISO 42001 requirement.

For each checklist item, mark the checkbox, record the current status (Not Started / In Progress / Done), and use the Notes column to capture evidence locations, responsible parties, or remediation actions.

01

Start with Clauses 4 and 5

Context and Leadership are foundational. If scope isn't defined and leadership commitment isn't documented, the rest of the AIMS lacks a legal basis.

02

Map existing ISO 27001 controls

If your organization holds ISO 27001, Clauses 4–10 share a near-identical High Level Structure. Map existing ISMS documentation before writing new documents.

03

Score each item in three states

Don't just tick or skip — use: Fully Implemented (evidence exists), Partially Implemented (process exists but docs incomplete), and Not Implemented (no current controls).

04

Assign remediation owners

Every gap item needs a named owner, target completion date, and evidence artifact type. Assign AI Governance Lead, Legal, HR, and IT leads to specific clause areas at least 90 days before audit.

4

CLAUSE 04

Context of the Organization

Define internal and external issues relevant to your AI systems, identify interested parties, and establish the scope of your AI Management System.

4.1 UNDERSTANDING THE ORGANIZATION AND ITS CONTEXT

□ REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐ Identify internal issues — Document internal factors relevant to AI: data infrastructure, technical capabilities, organizational culture, and existing management systems.		
☐ Identify external issues — Map external factors: applicable laws (EU AI Act, GDPR, sector regulations), competitive landscape, societal impact, and supply chain dependencies.		
☐ Monitor context regularly — Establish a process to review and update your context assessment at defined intervals or when significant changes occur.		

4.2 UNDERSTANDING THE NEEDS OF INTERESTED PARTIES

□ REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐ Identify interested parties — List all stakeholders: customers, regulators, employees, affected communities, shareholders, AI suppliers.		
☐ Determine relevant requirements — For each party, document their requirements — legal obligations, contractual terms, ethical expectations, transparency demands.		
☐ Track regulatory requirements — Maintain a register of applicable AI regulations and standards.		

4.3 DETERMINING THE SCOPE OF THE AIMS

□ REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐ Define AIMS scope — Document the boundaries: which AI systems, business units, geographies, and AI lifecycle stages are included.		
☐ Justify exclusions — Where any clause requirement is not applicable, document the justification.		
☐ Maintain scope document — The scope statement must be available as documented information and reviewed when context changes.		

4.4 AI MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

□ REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐ Establish, implement, maintain, and continually improve the AIMS in accordance with ISO 42001 requirements.		

5

CLAUSE 05

Leadership

ISO 42001 places explicit accountability on top management — not just the AI or IT team.

5.1 LEADERSHIP AND COMMITMENT

□ REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐ Top management accountability — Ensure top management takes ultimate accountability for AIMS effectiveness.		
☐ AIMS integration — Integrate AI management system requirements into business processes.		

□	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐	Resource allocation — Ensure adequate resources for the AIMS — budget, personnel, tools, and time.		
☐	Promote AI risk culture — Actively promote a culture of responsible AI across all levels.		

5.2 AI POLICY

□	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐	Establish AI policy — Document a formal AI policy appropriate to the purpose of the organization.		
☐	Commitment to satisfy requirements — Include a commitment to satisfy applicable ISO 42001 requirements.		
☐	Commitment to continual improvement — Explicitly state commitment to improving AIMS effectiveness.		
☐	Communicate and make available — Make AI policy available to all interested parties.		

5.3 ROLES, RESPONSIBILITIES, AND AUTHORITIES

□	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐	Assign AIMS responsibilities — Define and document who is responsible for AIMS conformance.		
☐	Reporting to top management — Ensure assigned roles have authority and reporting lines to top management.		

6

CLAUSE 06

Planning

Planning is where ISO 42001 diverges most sharply from a generic management system standard. Clause 6 requires AI-specific risk assessment methodology and measurable AI objectives.

6.1 ACTIONS TO ADDRESS RISKS AND OPPORTUNITIES

□	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐	AI risk assessment process — Establish and implement an AI risk assessment process covering data quality, model accuracy, bias, explainability, security, privacy, and societal impact.		
☐	AI system impact assessment — Conduct documented AI System Impact Assessments (AISIA) for each in-scope AI system.		
☐	Risk treatment plan — For each identified risk, document treatment options — accept, mitigate, transfer, or avoid — and assign risk owners.		
☐	Statement of Applicability (SoA) — Produce a Statement of Applicability documenting which Annex A controls have been selected, implemented, or excluded with justification.		
☐	Risk acceptance criteria — Define and document the criteria for accepting AI risks — thresholds, risk appetite, and governance approval requirements.		

6.2 AI OBJECTIVES AND PLANNING TO ACHIEVE THEM

□	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐	Set measurable AI objectives — Establish specific, measurable objectives at relevant functions and levels.		
☐	Consistent with AI policy — Objectives must align with and support the AI policy commitments.		
☐	Objective planning document — For each objective, document: what will be done, resources required, responsible party, completion timeline, and evaluation method.		

6.3 PLANNING OF CHANGES

□	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐	Change management for AIMS — When changes to the AIMS are needed, plan them in a controlled manner — considering purpose, consequences, resource availability, and responsibility allocation.		

7

CLAUSE 07

Support

Support covers the enabling infrastructure of your AIMS — from human resources and competence through documented information.

□	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐	7.1 Resources — Determine and provide the resources needed for AIMS establishment, implementation, maintenance, and continual improvement.		
☐	7.2 Competence — Assess gaps — Determine what AI-related competencies are required. Assess current levels. Document the gap.		
☐	7.2 Competence — Training plan — Implement training and development programs to close competence gaps. Retain evidence.		

☐	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐	7.3 Awareness — Ensure all relevant personnel are aware of the AI policy, their AIMS contribution, and consequences of non-conformance.		
☐	7.4 Communication — Establish internal and external communication processes covering AI governance.		
☐	7.5 Documented information — Create and update — Maintain all documented information required by ISO 42001.		
☐	7.5 Documented information — Control — Establish controls: version control, access controls, retention periods, and distribution management.		

8

CLAUSE 08

Operation

Clause 8 is the operational heart of ISO 42001 — where governance policies translate into concrete controls for AI system development, procurement, deployment, and management.

□	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐	8.1 Operational planning and control — Plan, implement, control, and maintain processes needed to meet AIMS requirements.		
☐	8.2 AI risk assessment — Perform AI risk assessments at planned intervals and when significant changes occur. Retain documented information.		
☐	8.3 AI risk treatment — Implement the AI risk treatment plan. Track treatment progress. Retain documented information of results.		
☐	8.4 AI system impact assessment — Conduct and document AI System Impact Assessments (AISIA) before deploying AI systems.		
☐	8.5 AI system lifecycle — Establish controls for each phase: data acquisition, model development, testing, deployment, monitoring, and decommissioning.		
☐	8.6 Supplier controls — Manage risks from AI-related suppliers and partners. Assess supplier AI governance practices.		
☐	8.7 Third-party AI systems — When acquiring AI systems from third parties, assess governance requirements, data handling, and explainability before procurement.		
☐	8.8 Documentation of AI systems — Maintain technical documentation for each AI system: training data, model architecture, performance metrics, known limitations.		

9

CLAUSE 09

Performance Evaluation

Performance evaluation is where many organizations struggle — particularly around defining meaningful AI monitoring metrics and conducting structured internal audits.

□	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐	9.1 Monitoring, measurement, analysis, and evaluation — Determine what needs to be monitored, the methods, when to perform monitoring, and when to analyze results.		
☐	AI performance metrics — Define and track AI governance metrics: model drift rates, bias indicators, data quality scores, incident rates.		
☐	9.2 Internal audit programme — Plan, establish, implement, and maintain an internal audit programme. Define audit criteria, scope, frequency, and methods.		
☐	9.2 Internal auditor competence — Select auditors competent in AI governance who can maintain objectivity.		
☐	9.3 Management review — Conduct management reviews at planned intervals. Review audit results, objective achievement, risk treatment status.		

□	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
☐	Management review outputs — Document decisions and actions. Outputs must include decisions on continual improvement and resource needs.		

10

CLAUSE 10

Improvement

Clause 10 closes the PDCA loop. For AI systems, continual improvement is especially critical — AI models degrade, regulatory requirements evolve, and new risks emerge.

□	REQUIREMENT	STATUS	NOTES
□	10.1 Continual improvement — Continually improve the suitability, adequacy, and effectiveness of the AIMS. This must be an active, planned process.		
□	10.2 Nonconformity identification — When a nonconformity occurs, react to control and correct it, evaluate the need for root cause action.		
□	10.2 Corrective action — Implement corrective actions. Review effectiveness. Update AIMS risks and opportunities if necessary.		
□	10.2 Retain evidence — Retain documented information as evidence of nonconformities, actions taken, and results of corrective action.		

A

ANNEX A

Key Controls Reference

Annex A provides 38 controls organized across 8 categories. Your Statement of Applicability (SoA) must address each control. The 12 highest-impact controls are listed below.

□ A.2.2 — AI Policy Policy · Organizational	□ A.2.5 — Responsibilities for AI Governance · Organizational
□ A.3.2 — Human oversight Process · Operational	□ A.4.2 — Transparency Communication · User-facing
□ A.5.2 — Fairness and non-discrimination Ethics · Model	□ A.5.4 — Data quality Data · Technical
□ A.6.1 — Data governance Data · Governance	□ A.6.2 — Data provenance Data · Documentation
□ A.7.2 — AI system testing Technical · Validation	□ A.7.4 — Feedback mechanism Process · Monitoring
□ A.8.2 — AI incident response Process · Operational	□ A.9.4 — AI system documentation Documentation · Technical

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